was to be more and more dependent on private sector investment for its future development. And the private sector will be, naturally, more interested in investing in the regions which have better infrastructure support. Since the developed regions have better infrastructure they will attract the highest level of private investment which will again accelerate the process of imbalanced growth. To tackle this problem, the centre is promoting the states with lower infrastructure so that they can overcome the disadvantage. The process is slower but at least the Government is addressing the issue which is not less satisfying and there is no criticism to this strategy. Still balanced growth and development is going to be a great challenge for planning in India.

3. Highly Centralised Nature of Planning

Decentralising the process of planning has been a major goal of the Governments since the 1950s itself. But after Nehru, with every Plan we see greater tendency of centralisation in the planning process. Setting up of the NDC and the promoting the multilevel planning (MLP) did not serve much purpose in the direction. It has been among the criticised areas of the planning in India as the National Planning Committee as well as the First Plan itself had called for ‘democratic planning’ in the country.

By the mid-1980s, the mindset of the centre went for a change and the need for decentralised planning got proper attention. Finally, by early 1990s two constitutional Amendments (i.e the 73rd and the 74th) promoted the cause of decentralised planning by delegating constitutional powers to the local bodies. With this, a new era of planning began but still the planning of the local bodies is in the nascent stage due to lack of proper financial provisions for them. Once the financial provisions for them are evolved to the adequate level or the local bodies are given financial autonomy, the process of decentralised planning will surely get a new direction and meaning, as the experts believe.

In the meantime, the Tenth Plan emphasised upon a greater role for the states in the planning process. The Plan started a concerted effort to include the states’ participation in the national planning process. The Centre is